The AI Last-Mile Checklist

Twelve checks before the next AI purchase

For owners and managers in Litchfield County and Hartford

Twelve things to check before you buy another AI tool.
If the last purchase is sitting half-used, start at number one and work down.

1 Who holds the license

Look at: the account the tool is billed to, and what happens to it when that person leaves.

Why it matters: if the license lives in somebody's personal account, the work leaves with their login and you can't audit who did what.

2 What actually went in

Look at: the last quarter of chat history and browser history, for client names, financials or health details.

Why it matters: once it's in the vendor's system you can't call it back, and a client contract may already have been broken.

3 The document the assistant can't find

Look at: a question whose answer sits on page 40 of a policy PDF, and ask the assistant the same question.

Why it matters: most assistants answer from general training data and sound just as confident when they're wrong.

4 The permission model

Look at: who can see the HR folder, the executive folder and the client matter folder, and whether the AI tool inherits those permissions.

Why it matters: a search tool doesn't create oversharing. It makes oversharing faster to find.

5 The workflow it was meant to change

Look at: the one workflow you bought it for, and count how many times a week it runs now.

Why it matters: “use AI more” isn't a workflow, so it can't succeed or fail, and the spend never gets judged.

6 The person who signs off

Look at: who checks the output before it leaves the building, and what they're allowed to send back.

Why it matters: without an approver, every mistake the assistant makes becomes the firm's mistake.

7 The baseline number

Look at: the before number, the after number and the date on the pilot report.

Why it matters: with no baseline the vendor's slide is the only evidence, and the renewal gets decided on it.

8 The training that happened

Look at: ask three staff to show you the prompt or feature they use every week.

Why it matters: a launch email isn't training, and unused licenses renew at the same price as used ones.

9 The support path

Look at: the name and the response time you get when it breaks on a Monday morning.

Why it matters: an assistant that stops working in a busy week gets abandoned, and you've paid for the year.

10 The renewal and the exit

Look at: the notice period, the seat count you're paying for, and where the data goes if you leave.

Why it matters: the cheapest time to negotiate an exit is before you need one.

11 The audit log

Look at: whether the admin audit log is switched on, and who reads it.

Why it matters: without a record you can't answer a client who asks who saw their file.

12 The next purchase

Look at: whether the last tool earned the next one, and what would have to be true before you buy again.

Why it matters: buying another tool is the most expensive way to skip finishing the first.

Stuck on one of these? The AI Reset call is free and it takes 30 minutes. Bring the check that failed.

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